

Andhra Pradesh. It is even more amusing to see TDP chief Chandrababu Naidu hobnobbing with the Left when he had opposed their populism not too long ago. RAGHAVENDRA. S.A., Secunderabad

Straw in the Wind

By developing a wind power generation system, Rahul Bajaj has set an example worth emulating ("Greener Pastures", August 13). He has proved that India can lead the world in clean electricity generation owing to its vast sources of renewable energy. Corporate houses ought to encash this lucrative opportunity. VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, Dehradun

Sharif Dilemma

Much water has flown under the bridge since Nawaz Sharif left Pakistan ("I can't be Musharraf's Dummy", August 13). With Pakistan becoming a veritable tinderbox, it will be a Herculean task for a civilian dispensation to usher normalcy in the country. And if a desperate Musharraf were to strike a deal with former Pakistan prime minister Benazir Bhutto, to hold on to power, chances are that Sharif would get sidelined yet again. NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, Thiruvananthapuram

Lopsided Media

While thousands of people have been washed away in floods in Bihar, Assam and other states, the media has been going ballistic with Sanjay Dutt's conviction ("Babloid Babus", August 13). The magazine is right

when it points out that we are more interested in Dutt's blue shirt than the plight of the homeless. SOM SHARMA, Gurgaon

Cold Comfort

Appeasing the warring factions as also his allies and quelling any dissent in his ranks has made General Musharraf take unpopular decisions ("Musharraf's Last Stand", August 6). Uneasy lies the head that wears the crown. PACHU MENON, Margao

Museums of Shame

It is sad to see the pathetic state which the museums of the country are in today when one compares them to those in the G-8 countries ("Shame on Silicon Valley", June 25). To modernise such dilapidated structures, one can use satellite links with other museums of the world to bring to India the museums of the 21st century. K.K. PURI, Toronto, Canada



There is a feeling that the reason why so much praise is being heaped upon A.P.J. Abdul Kalam is that his successor is a bit "shady" ("Salaam Kalam", August 6).

PRAMOD SOOD, Shimla

The difference between the two presidents is here to see: while Kalam spoke about his Vision 2020 and his dream for the nation, in her maiden speech as the country's President, Pratibha Patil glorified Nehru, Sardar Patel and Maulana Azad and paid just lip service to Mahatma Gandhi.

MANASH RANJAN GHOSE, Kolkata

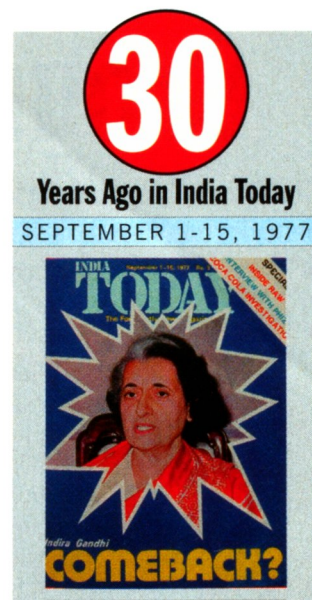
If even half of our politicians possessed a bit of Kalam's vision and commitment to the nation, the country would have ranked among the most progressive and powerful nations of the world.

SANTOSH KAPOOR, Noida

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Return to Respectability

The Communist Party of India (Marxist) faces the same problem as a congenital nudist presented with a three-piece Saville Row suit in his favourite club. Since 1971, the party has been hounded by the forces of government and the storm troopers of the Congress. In spite of all this, the CPI(M), almost phoenix-like, emerged from the ashes to



win an absolute majority in the recent elections. As the dapper hero, Jyoti Basu took oath as chief minister, the political situation in West Bengal saw a complete transformation. The first change was the replacement of hardliner P. Sundarayya by former Kerala chief minister E.M.S. Namboodiripad as the party's general secretary. The final decision was a classic compromise—the government would be run as a bourgeois government and all efforts will be made to resolve problems through negotiation, adjudication and arbitration.

—C. Joshi